

Education for Our Futures Brief

Introduction

Education for Our Futures (EFOF) is a student collective that seeks to rethink the U.S. K-12 space through a comprehensive blueprint and evaluations of education technology. EFOF acts as the first movement in the modern education space principally led by students in three distinct sectors: the infrastructure of schools, the systematic process of districts, and the technology that students utilize for growth. As a collective, EFOF has noticed that the U.S. public education is poised for groundbreaking transformation as technology evolves at a far more rapid rate than schools themselves. EFOF's mission is to ensure students are ready for the future, by re-evaluating the purpose and values of education.

Project Management

Education for Our Futures deploys two strategies to tackle the lack of student voice in the education space. The first, the blueprint, stems from a belief that as the face of the educational space changes, entities with different views will dictate policy decisions and priorities. A student specific blueprint will engage the principal stakeholder of education and has room to uniquely contribute to policy discussion. The EFOF blueprint for education will be portrayed in categorical videos and briefs; we aim to make the content easily accessible to the average student. EFOF is facilitating coordination between researchers and students to articulate the projections of K-12 in 4 separate sectors under a 2035 timeline. This blueprint will serve as a functional model for schools, districts, state boards of education, education technology companies, and policymakers to incrementally advance youth priorities in the education space. EFOF's second strategy engages another significant stakeholder in the future of K-12: education-technology companies. The Stanford Accelerator for Learning found only a mere 11% of superintendents evaluate technology before purchasing it for their district. As a solution, EFOF conducts product reviews for ed-tech companies with a diverse set of students from across the country. These students evaluate the products on a rubric consisting of UI/UX, level of engagement, accessibility, personalization, and support for deeper understanding. These evaluations serve the purpose of both extending the reach of education technology products and ensuring districts make knowledgeable decisions.

Resources and Expectations

The success of EFOF depends on 3 groups of individuals. Principally, EFOF relies on "school representatives" from across the nation to ensure there is collective insight for the blueprint, along with diversity in backgrounds to ensure our evaluations accommodate every need. The second is a board of advisors: composed of researchers, entrepreneurs, and policymakers in the education realm who are willing to guide and collaborate the movement. Finally, we seek the trust of companies to evaluate their products, solely in the name of a better education for every student. EFOF's short term goal (Sept 2025) is to accumulate 2000 school representatives and run a pilot evaluation for an edtech company. EFOF has the long term goal of influencing every district in the United States.